3.3 Assignment

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Professor Predict — Learning Summary

Completed

Throughout this exercise, you explored how large language models learn through next-token prediction during pretraining and receive additional post-training to improve their responses. You discovered that fluent answers are not always accurate. Your response to the fictional Velmora question demonstrated the importance of questioning unfamiliar information rather than accepting every premise.

You also recognized that low-resource languages face limitations because of insufficient training materials. In the Good Fit and Danger Zone exercise, you correctly identified current stock prices and private conversations as tasks requiring additional verification.

Most importantly, you concluded that AI users should remain naturally curious, question whether AI is appropriate for a situation, and double-check information to prevent mistakes.

□ Badge Unlocked!

Knows Why the Robot Sometimes Makes Stuff Up

Personal Reflection

This activity helped me better understand how large language models work and why their responses should not always be taken as factual information. One of my biggest takeaways is that AI generates responses based on learned patterns rather than independently verifying every piece of information. I was particularly surprised by the limitations of AI when working with low-resource languages because the availability and diversity of training data can significantly affect model performance. I also learned that AI is not necessarily the best solution for every situation, especially when dealing with real-time information, confidential information, or tasks requiring precise calculations. Moving forward, I want to remain naturally curious about whether using AI is appropriate for a particular situation instead of automatically relying on it. I will also make a conscious effort to question AI-generated information and double-check important details to minimize errors. Ultimately, AI should complement human judgment rather than replace critical thinking.